# KenTender Module Guide: Requisitions

Oct 17, 2026

## What Requisitions is for

When it is time to buy, the user department raises a requisition against an item in the approved annual plan. The requisition says exactly what is wanted: the equipment items, the minimum technical characteristics each must meet, any related services such as warranty and support, and how the goods will be checked on delivery. It also states the estimated cost for each source of funding the plan item draws on.

The head of the user department submits it. The Head of Procurement Function then authorises it or returns it. At the moment of authorisation, two things happen together: the plan's allowance for that item is drawn down, and the money is reserved on the budget lines. Tender Preparation then builds the tender from the authorised requisition.

The first release covers one kind of purchase: straightforward off-the-shelf IT equipment, supplied in Kenya Shillings as a single lot.

**What it hands on:** an authorised requisition with its money held and its specification fixed as structured rows, ready for tender preparation.

**Why it matters:** no tender can start unless a planned, certified and funded requirement stands behind it. The money is reserved and the plan is drawn down in the same step, so the entity never goes to market for something it cannot afford, and a purchase cannot be split or repeated to slip past the plan.

## Who uses it

The department prepares and certifies the requisition. Procurement authorises it. Nobody else makes a decision.

| Who | What they can do |
|---|---|
| Departmental Author | Prepares a requisition for their department: the items, the requirements and the estimated cost. Sends a finished one to the head of department for approval. |

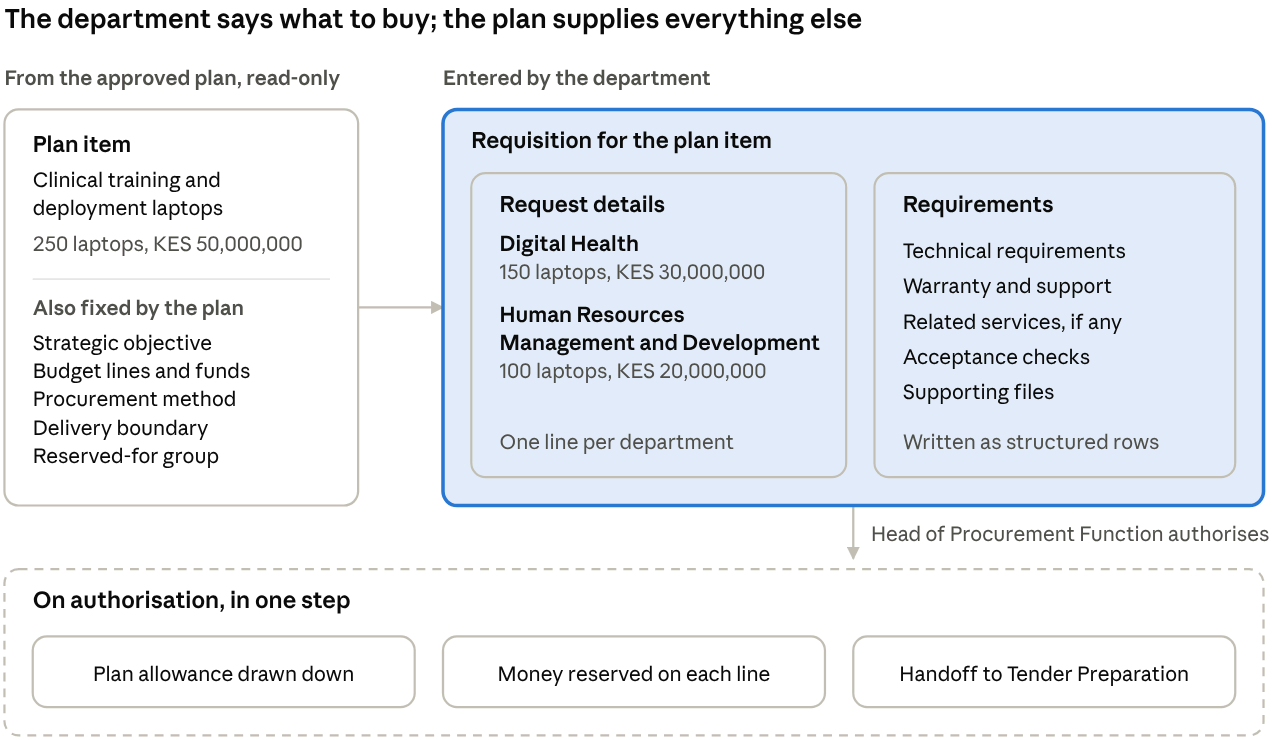
| Who | What they can do |
|---|---|
| Head of User Department | Sees the whole requisition for their department. Can prepare and submit one directly, or approve an Author's. Submits it to Procurement, returns it for correction, or withdraws it before authorisation. |
| Head of Procurement Function | Sees the complete submitted requisition with fresh plan and budget availability. Authorises it, returns it, or revokes an authorisation that has not yet been used. Cannot edit the requirements. |
| Procurement Planner | Reads the plan lineage and the plan's drawdown. Receives requests to correct the plan. Makes no decision on the requisition. |
| Procurement Officer | Takes the authorised requisition forward in Tender Preparation. Has no drafting right here. |
| Accounting Officer | Reads authorised requisitions with their decisions and history. Changes nothing. |
| Auditor | Reads versions, decisions, drawdowns, reservations and handoffs. Changes nothing. |
| System administrators | Can read every record for support, and decide nothing. |

When one plan item was formed from several departments' needs, a single requisition can carry exactly those departments and no others. Each department's Author works only on their own department's lines, and the head of the lead department certifies the whole requisition once on behalf of all of them. The lead is the department with the largest value in the requisition, and the Head of Procurement Function can change it, with a reason, by returning the requisition for the new lead to certify.

The person who certified a requisition cannot also authorise it. An Author cannot take the head's decision on the same requisition unless they independently hold that role and prepared it directly in that capacity. A job title grants nothing: every action is checked against the person's current assignment and department.

# What a requisition contains

A requisition is raised against exactly one item in the approved plan. The plan item supplies a great deal and the department can change none of it. The department supplies two things: the request details and the requirements.




requisition contents · Ministry of Health laptops requisition

**From the plan, read-only.** The need and expected result, the strategic objective, the budget lines and funding source, the procurement method and schedule, the delivery boundary, and the planned reservation group. They are shown as facts from the approved plan. If one is wrong, the fix is a correction to the plan, never an edit here.

**Request details.** For each department's share of the plan item, the department lists the equipment items it wants and enters one estimated total cost. The quantity is never typed separately: a line's quantity is the sum of its items, and it cannot exceed what the plan still has available. The estimated cost cannot exceed the remaining value, is never prefilled and is never calculated from a rate. It is the department's estimate, not a supplier's price. The request also states where and by when delivery is needed, which can be earlier than the plan's boundary but never later.

**Requirements.** Every requirement is a separate structured row, such as a minimum of 16 GB of memory or a required list of ports. For each item the system proposes a starting set; for laptops that covers the technical specification, warranty and support, and acceptance checks. The department sees every proposed value, changes or clears what it needs, and confirms the set before the request can be submitted. Each row records which items it covers, so a customised laptop gets its own row without changing the others.

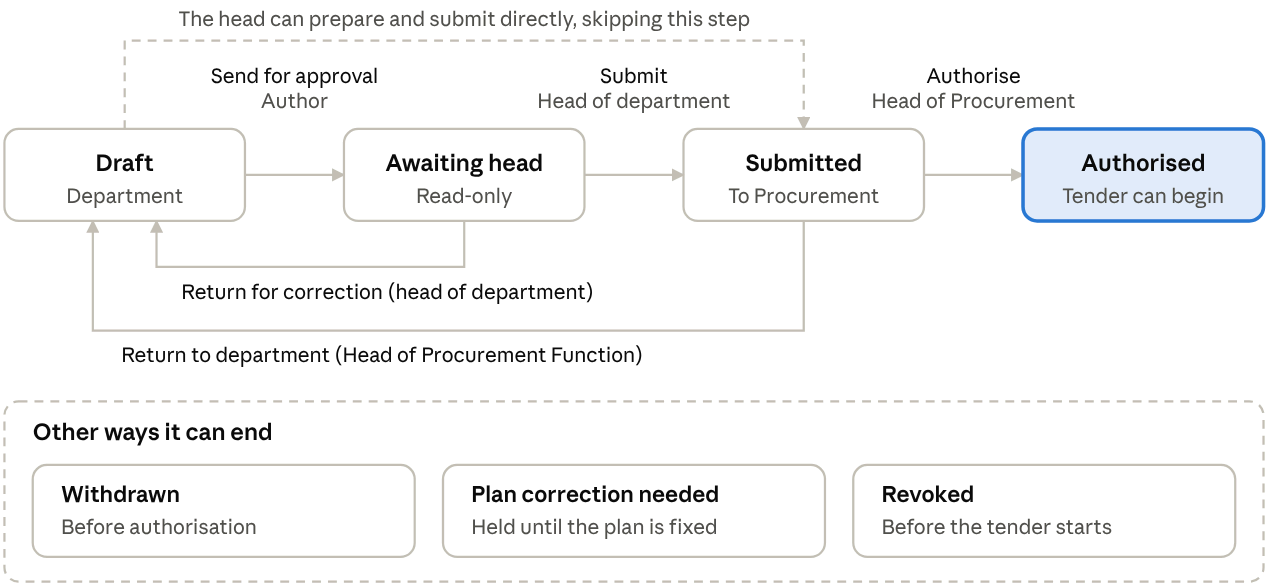
Four kinds of requirement are stored. **Technical** requirements are minimums, exact values or required features drawn from a fixed catalogue. **Related services** appear only if services are wanted, such as installation or training, and each states the result, the date and the evidence. **Acceptance checks** must state an observable pass condition, so "satisfactory" is not accepted. **Supporting files** such as drawings or photographs can accompany a row but can never be the only statement of an obligation.

A brand, model or named technology is blocked unless the text allows an equivalent and records a functional reason. The system does not rewrite a restrictive requirement for the department.

## How a requisition moves from draft to authorised

A requisition is a draft until it is submitted, and then it is read-only. Two people look at it in turn, the head of the department and the Head of Procurement Function, and each can return it. Only the second can authorise it.

**A requisition is authorised only by someone who did not certify it**




requisition lifecycle · four main states, two return loops, one skipped step, three other endings

The journey, step by step:

1. **Start.** The Author or the head starts a requisition from a plan item shown as *Purchase ready for requisition*. The system first checks that the item suits this release: goods, a single lot, Kenya Shillings, open tender, a single year, and a reservation group the tender format supports. A plan item that fails is refused before any draft exists. Only one requisition can be open for a plan item at a time.
2. **Prepare.** The department completes the request details and the requirements, then reviews the whole request. The screen shows what is still missing, and the draft can be saved at any point.
3. **Send for approval.** An Author sends the finished draft to the head of the lead department, who certifies it once for every department involved. A head who prepared it directly submits straight to Procurement.
4. **Authorise or return.** The Head of Procurement Function sees the complete requisition with fresh plan and budget availability. *Authorise* draws down the plan and reserves the money in a single step, and creates the handoff for the tender. *Return to department* needs a written reason, and a copied draft opens at the section that needs work. Returning never touches the plan or the budget.
5. **Withdraw.** The head can withdraw a draft or a submitted requisition. Nothing was drawn or reserved, so nothing needs releasing.

6. **Plan correction.** If the plan itself is wrong, the head or the Head of Procurement Function asks Planning to correct it. The requisition stops and the plan item's new authorisations are held until Planning decides. The requisition never restarts on its own: the department can start a fresh one once the correction is in force, or if Planning closes the request unchanged.
7. **Revoke.** Before Tender Preparation has taken up the handoff, the Head of Procurement Function can revoke an authorisation. The plan draw and the money reservation are reversed together, and the department can prepare a corrected draft. After the tender has started, a change goes through Tender Preparation's own correction route instead.

If a different department should lead, the Head of Procurement Function can return the requisition with a reason and name another contributing department. The new lead's head then certifies it afresh. The earlier certification is never relabelled.

## What happens at authorisation

Authorisation is the one moment a requisition touches the plan and the budget. Until then, drafting, submitting, returning and withdrawing change no balance anywhere. At authorisation the system does four things together: it records the decision, draws the plan's allowance, reserves the money, and creates the handoff for the tender. All four happen, or none do.

Before it commits, the system checks the submitted requisition again, as it stands, against the world as it is now:

- the plan item is still in the plan in force, with the quantity and value the requisition asks for still available;
- the plan item has no unresolved correction request holding new authorisations;
- the plan's funding evidence is current;
- the requisition still suits this release (goods, one lot, Kenya Shillings, open tender, a single year, and a reservation group the tender format supports);
- the dates still fit inside the plan's boundary;
- the person authorising holds the Head of Procurement Function responsibility now, and is not the person who certified it.

**The money.** The system asks Budget once, for the complete set of lines together. Budget adds up what the requisition needs on each budget line before testing availability, so two lines that are each affordable cannot together overspend a shared line. If it passes, Budget makes one reservation for each department's line, for exactly the estimated cost

entered. In the demonstration data the laptops requisition makes two reservations, KES 30,000,000 for Digital Health and KES 20,000,000 for Human Resources Management and Development. It does not make one reservation of KES 50,000,000.

**The plan.** At the same moment, Planning records the draw against the plan item's remaining allowance and fixes the item's scope for good. A later requisition can use only the original allowance that is left.

**What it does not do.** Authorisation creates no tender, picks no tender template and approves no budget. Repeating the same request, say after a lost reply, returns the first result and never creates a second reservation.

**Revoking.** Before Tender Preparation has taken up the handoff, the Head of Procurement Function can revoke the authorisation. The plan draw and every reservation are then reversed together, once. Once Tender Preparation takes up the handoff, the requisition no longer occupies the plan item, so another requisition can be raised against any allowance that is left. The draw and the reservations stay with the tender: taking up the handoff neither reverses the draw nor releases any money, and any later change belongs to Tender Preparation and the modules after it.

## What the rest of the system takes from an authorised requisition

The requisition's main output is the **handoff**: one fixed record, created at authorisation, that Tender Preparation builds the tender from. Requisitions also depends on Planning and Budget, and each of them reaches it only through published services.

| Who | What passes |
|---|---|
| Tender Preparation | The handoff. It contains the plan item and its strategic objective and path; every equipment item; every technical, service and acceptance row with its own identifier and the items it covers; the supporting files; each department's line with its reservation; the planned method, schedule and budget lines; the reservation group; and the two decisions, the head's certification and the Head of Procurement Function's authorisation. It holds no price, supplier or evaluation score. |

| Who | What passes |
|---|---|
| Planning | Planning tells Requisitions which plan items are ready, with the quantity and value left on each. Requisitions asks Planning to draw the allowance at authorisation, to reverse it on revocation, and to correct a plan item when it finds a fault. |
| Budget | One check across all lines, then one reservation per line, in the same step as authorisation. On revocation, every reservation is released with the draw. |
| Contract Management | Later, the awarded values and the obligations carry through from the same rows, with nothing retyped. |
| Anyone who raises requisitions | A *Purchase ready for requisition* row appears in the workspace for the Author and the head of each department contributing to a plan item as soon as the plan is in force. It disappears when a requisition occupies the item or its allowance is used up. |

**One handoff, taken up once.** Tender Preparation takes up the handoff in the same step as it creates its draft tender, so a handoff can never be taken up by two tenders, and a revocation can never slip in between. From that moment the Head of Procurement Function can no longer revoke it. If the tender's draft cannot be created, the take-up is undone too.

**What Tender Preparation may not do.** It keeps every identifier, shows the inherited requirements read-only, and cannot omit or rewrite an authorised obligation. The goods, delivery and price schedules are produced from the item rows, and every technical requirement gets its own line for the supplier's answer. Two laptops covered by the same rows share one line in the tender. A laptop the department customised has a line of its own.

**What it deliberately leaves out.** The handoff carries the item's own reservation group, not the plan-wide reserved-share target. Requisitions never works that out. A budget reservation created here is a separate financial hold and is never counted as meeting the reserved-share target.

## Safeguards

- **Authority comes from assignment, within a department.** A department sees and works on only its own requisitions. On a shared plan item, only the departments that formed it take part. A title alone grants nothing.
- **No one authorises their own work.** The person who certified a requisition cannot authorise it, and the Head of Procurement Function cannot edit what the department wrote.
- **The plan sets the limits.** One open requisition per plan item; quantities and estimated costs within what the plan has left; delivery no later than the plan's boundary. What the plan fixed cannot be changed here.
- **Requirements are specific and fair.** Every obligation is a structured row, acceptance checks state an observable pass condition, a brand needs an "or equivalent" and a functional reason, and a file is never the only statement of an obligation.
- **Money moves only at authorisation.** Drafting, submitting, returning and withdrawing change no balance. Authorisation checks every line together, then draws the plan and reserves the money in one step, or not at all.
- **Submitted means fixed.** A submitted requisition never changes; a return opens a copy. Revoking before the tender takes up the handoff reverses the draw and the reservations together.
- **History is kept.** Versions, decisions, drawdowns, reservations and handoffs are only added to, each with who acted, in which role and when.